

NITISH KUMAR PANDA

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Professional Summary

Level Designer & Environment Specialist with expertise in **Unreal Engine 5**. Specialized in creating immersive gameplay spaces with a focus on player flow, spatial storytelling, and technical optimization (Nanite, LODs, Lumen). Proven track record in designing stealth layouts, system design, and economy loops.

Technical Skills

Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (Specialist), Unity
Level Design: Greyboxing/Whiteboxing, Combat Pacing, Player Flow, Spatial Puzzles, Navigation
Tech Art Pipeline: Optimization (Nanite, LODs), Lighting (Lumen, Volumetrics), Niagara VFX Basics
Game Design: GDD Documentation, Economy Loops, System Design, Progression Systems

Experience

Assassin: The First List (Steam Release) Nov. 2024 – Present
Level Designer Remote

- Designed and polished **4 full stealth levels** from initial blockout to final high-fidelity environment.
- Developed non-linear level architecture with strategic verticality, enabling multiple stealth approaches.
- Designed AI guard patrol routes and encounter positioning to maximize player tension.
- Utilized composition and lighting to ensure objective readability in dense environments.

Gamer2Maker Oct. 2024 – Present
Level Designer / Game Developer Remote

- Collaborated on professional level design pipelines and environment optimization techniques.
- Implemented technical workflows including LOD management and Lumen lighting for real-time projects.

Projects

3D Hustle | *Unreal Engine, Itch.io* Jan. 2025

- Lead Designer: Authored the complete **Game Design Document (GDD)** and core economy loops.
- Engineered progression systems and spatial navigation mechanics for a high-readability platformer.
- Optimized collision and platforming geometry to maintain player momentum and flow.

Psych Horror Prototype | *Unreal Engine, Lumen* Dec. 2024

- Designed an atmospheric horror level utilizing negative space and high-contrast volumetric lighting.
- Controlled emotional pacing through claustrophobic spatial design and shadow-driven storytelling.

Co-op Level Design (Confidential) | *Unreal Engine* Nov. 2024

- Developed synchronized co-op puzzles requiring dual-player spatial coordination and communication.
- Managed split-path navigation to ensure balanced engagement for both players.

The Dyeing World | *Unreal Engine, 3D Platformer* Oct. 2024

- Used color-coded environment shapes to naturally guide player movement through exploration zones.

Santas Revenge (Game Jam) | *Unity, Arena Combat* Dec. 2024

- Designed a linear combat arena and enemy encounter pacing under a strict **48-hour deadline**.

Education

Gamer2Maker 2024
Game Design Certification Online

KIIT University 2019
Master's Degree Bhubaneswar, India